

WITH THE **VIKRAMADITYA** DELAY, THE NAVY WILL HAVE AIRCRAFT BUT NO CARRIER

DELHI | CARRIER MOVES

Beginning September, the first batch of Indian naval aviators will start deck-landing training on the sole Russian aircraft carrier, the *Admiral Kuznetsov*. This is the final phase of their carrier qualification. The *Kuznetsov* is the only carrier which uses 'short take off but arrested recovery' (STOBAR) to launch fighters. The *Vikramaditya*, the ex-*Admiral Gorshkov*, bought by India also uses STOBAR but the impasse on its refit costs is a spanner in the works. Defence officials say the *Vikramaditya*'s induction could be delayed and it may arrive in India by 2014. Deliveries of all the *Vikramaditya*'s 16 MiG-29 K aircraft are set to be completed in two years. That would leave the navy with aircraft but no carrier, compelling them to be land-based, on the Shore Based Test Facility, a mock aircraft carrier in Goa.

by Sandeep Unnithan



THE ADMIRAL KUZNETSOV

AP PHOTO

BANGALORE | Right as Rain

Aiming to create awareness about water conservation, a 48,000 sq ft rainwater harvesting theme park was opened in the city recently. A result of the combined efforts of the Karnataka Government and the Karnataka Science and Technology Academy, the park houses an information centre teaching the rudiments of rainwater harvesting, with a multimedia centre to follow soon. There are more than 20 models of rainwater harvesting displayed in the park. "Water saved is water gained, and we want citizens to learn water conservation. This is one of the many ways of doing so," says Chief Minister B.S. Yeddyurappa. With groundwater getting depleted and lakes drying up at an alarming speed, rainwater harvesting is an idea whose time has come. by Stephen David

KARNATAKA HAS OPENED A 48,000-SQ FT THEME PARK TO EDUCATE THE PUBLIC ON HARVESTING RAINWATER.

KOLKATA | Kid Stuff

After NGOs, it has now come to schoolchildren in Kolkata to restore a heritage park. Once a bustling beauty but now in ruins, the water tank at Victoria Park had turned into a public toilet and bathing space. Students from the elite Birla High School, La Martiniere for Boys, La Martiniere for Girls, Ashok Hall and Modern High School persuaded the Kolkata Municipal Corporation (KMC) to support a clean-up initiative. The children recently joined hands with a KMC team and spruced up half the premises over an eight-hour operation. The clean-up continues and the children will soon form a management committee for maintenance of the park.

by Abhijit Dasgupta



SCHOOLCHILDREN IN ACTION AT THE VICTORIA PARK

ABHIJIT DASGUPTA

Robotopper

Designed by the students of the Birla Institute of Technology and Science (BITS, Pilani), the AcYut-II robot has won the bronze medal in the middle weight humanoid category at the 2009 RoboGames held in San Francisco. This is India's first medal ever in the competition. Over 250 teams from 28 countries had participated in the event.

AcYut, meaning the one who never falls in Sanskrit, was the only Indian humanoid in the competition.

by Nandini Vaish

THE ACYUT-II ROBOT

